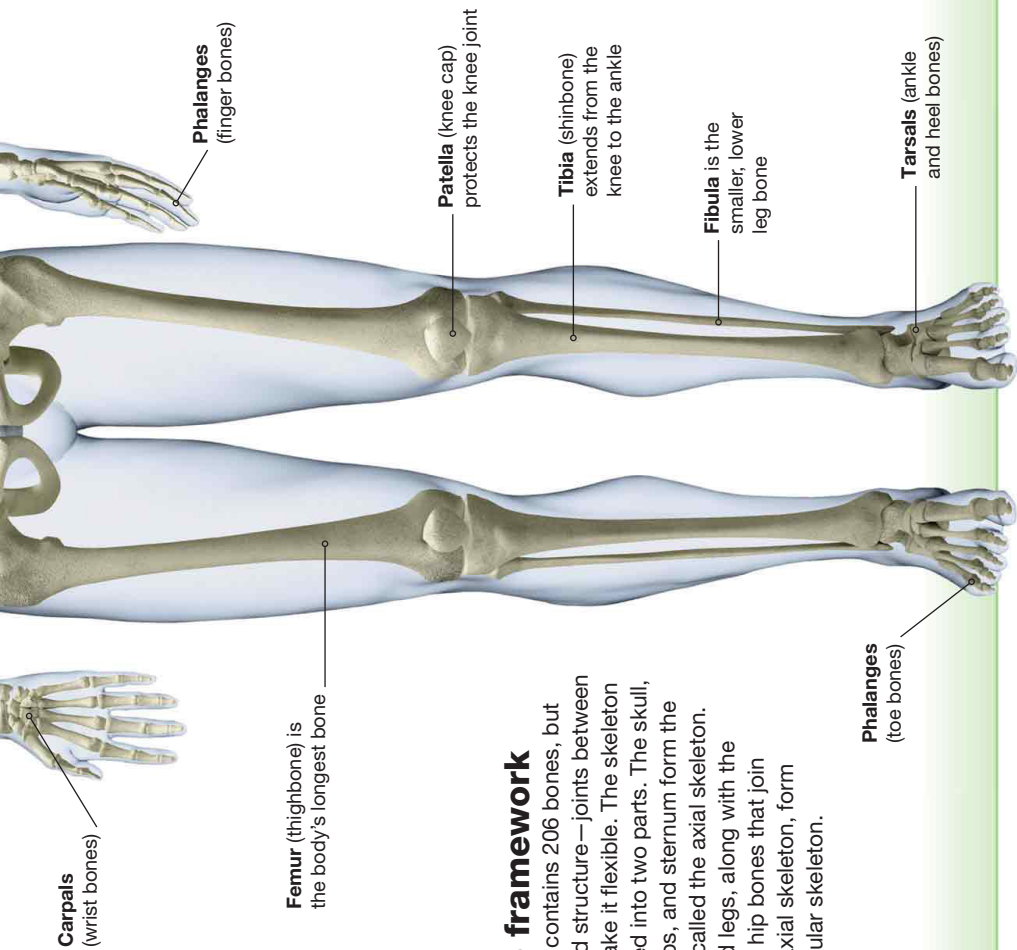




Flexible framework

The skeleton contains 206 bones, but it is not a rigid structure—joints between the bones make it flexible. The skeleton can be divided into two parts. The skull, backbone, ribs, and sternum form the central part, called the axial skeleton. The arms and legs, along with the shoulder and hip bones that join them to the axial skeleton, form the appendicular skeleton.